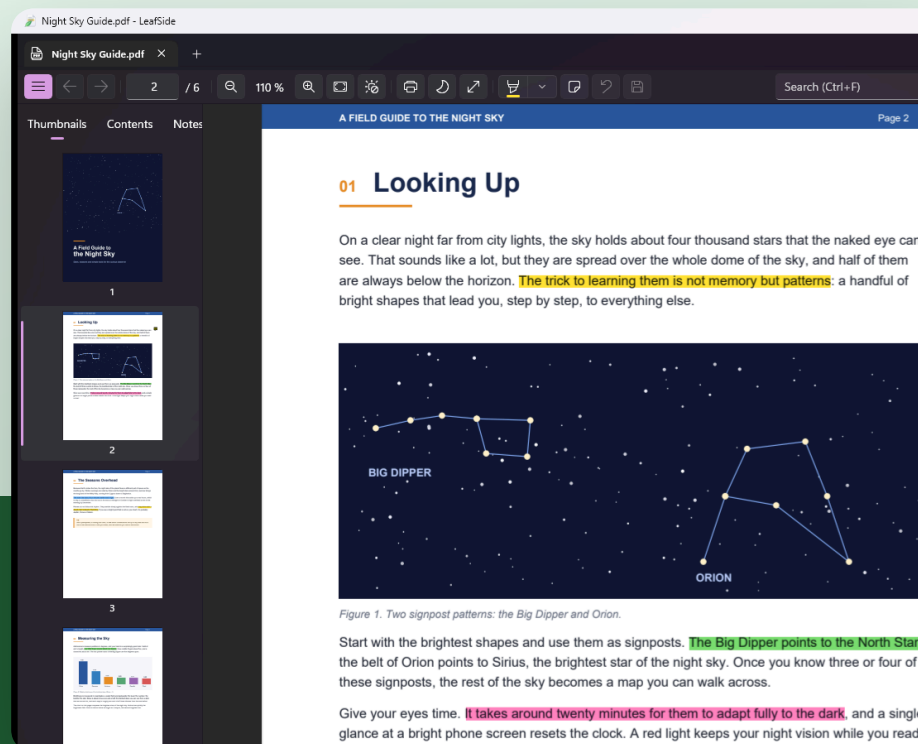




LeafSide

User guide

A fast, no-fuss PDF reader for Windows. Read, highlight, take notes and pick up right where you left off.



1 Welcome

Thanks for trying LeafSide. This guide walks you through everything, from installing it to getting the most out of it. No need to read it cover to cover: jump to whatever you need.

LeafSide is a PDF reader built to make reading pleasant: scrolling stays smooth even in huge documents, text is sharp at any zoom, and you can highlight and annotate without leaving the app. It runs on Intel and AMD PCs and on Windows on Arm devices (such as Surface laptops with Snapdragon).



No account, no ads

Nothing to sign up for. Your documents never leave your computer.



Remembers your place

Every PDF reopens on the same page, at the same zoom.



Notes inside the PDF

Highlights and notes are saved in the file itself, so any other reader shows them too.



Made for reading

Night mode, full screen, pinch zoom and double-tap zoom.

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2 Installing LeafSide

Download LeafSide from github.com/Jmzp/leafside/releases. You'll see four files. Pick one based on your PC and how you'd like to install it:

Your PC	Installer (recommended)	Portable version
Intel or AMD PC (most PCs)	...-win-x64.msi	...-win-x64.zip
Windows on Arm (Snapdragon)	...-win-arm64.msi	...-win-arm64.zip

Not sure which PC you have?

Open **Settings > System > About** and look at **System type**. If it says "x64-based processor", use x64; if it mentions ARM, use arm64.

With the installer (.msi)

- 1 Double-click the **.msi** file you downloaded.
- 2 Accept the license and click **Install**. No administrator rights needed: it installs for your user only.
- 3 When it's done, you'll find **LeafSide – PDF Reader** in the Start menu.

With the portable version (.zip)

- 1 Right-click the .zip > **Extract All**. Extract the **whole** zip into a folder, such as Documents\LeafSide. Don't run it from inside the zip.
- 2 Open the folder and double-click **LeafSide.exe**.

Seeing "Windows protected your PC"?

That's expected: the app isn't digitally signed yet. Click **More info**, then **Run anyway**. You'll only be asked once.

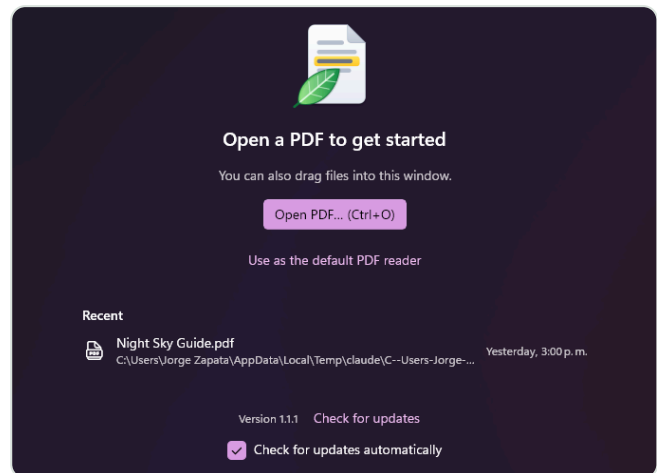
3

Opening your PDFs

When LeafSide starts with no document open, you'll see the start page. From here there are several ways to open a PDF:

- Click **Open PDF...** or press **Ctrl** + **O**.
- **Drag** one or more files onto the window.
- Click a file under **Recent**. Right-click it to remove it from the list or open its folder.
- From File Explorer: right-click a PDF > **Open with** > LeafSide.

If LeafSide is already open, new PDFs open as tabs in the same window.



The start page, with your recent files.

Make LeafSide your default PDF reader

- 1 On the start page, click **Use as the default PDF reader**. Windows Settings opens.
- 2 Search for **.pdf** and choose **LeafSide – PDF Reader**.

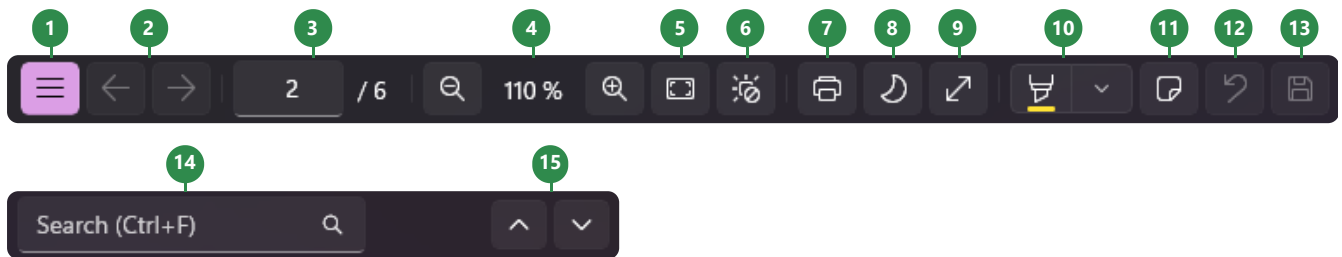
Another way: right-click any PDF > **Open with** > **Choose another app** > LeafSide > **Always**.

Password-protected PDF?

LeafSide asks for the password when you open it. You can read it as usual, though highlights and notes can't be added to protected PDFs.

4 The toolbar

Everything you need is in the bar at the top. Can't remember what a button does? Rest the mouse on it for a second to see its name and shortcut.



- | | |
|---|--|
| 1 Side panel: thumbnails, contents and notes | 2 Back / Forward: return to where you were after a jump |
| 3 Go to page: type a number and press Enter | 4 Zoom: out, current level, in |
| 5 Fit width of the window | 6 Whole page: see the entire page |
| 7 Print | 8 Night mode |
| 9 Full screen | 10 Highlighter: the arrow picks the color |
| 11 Add note | 12 Undo the last change |
| 13 Save highlights and notes into the PDF | 14 Search the document |
| 15 Previous / next match | |

5 Getting around

Scrolling and zooming

- **Scroll** with the mouse wheel, touchpad, your finger, or **PgUp** / **PgDn** and **Space**. **Home** and **End** go to the first and last page.
- **Zoom:** pinch with two fingers, use **Ctrl** + mouse wheel, or **Ctrl** + **+** / **Ctrl** + **-**. Anywhere from 10 % to 1000 %.
- **Double-click or double-tap** the page to zoom in on that spot. Do it again to go back to fit width; **Ctrl** + **0** does the same.

Jump anywhere

- Type a number in the page box (or press **Ctrl** + **G**) and press Enter.
- Open the **side panel** (button 1): **Thumbnails** shows every page and **Contents** shows the document's chapters, if it has them. Click to go there.
- **Links** in the PDF work: internal ones take you to another page, web links open in your browser.
- Jumped and want to go back? Use **Back** (**Alt** + **←**) or your mouse's side "back" button.

Copying text

Drag across text to select it, then press **Ctrl** + **C**, or right-click > **Copy**. It works with a pen too.

6 Searching

Press **Ctrl** + **F** (or click the **Search** box), type what you're looking for and press Enter. Every match is highlighted in the document, and you'll see how many there are, such as "3 of 12".

- **F3** or **Enter** goes to the next match; **Shift** + **F3** to the previous one. The arrows next to the box do the same.
- In very long documents, the search keeps running in the background while you read.

7 Tabs and memory

- Open several PDFs at once: each gets its own **tab**. Use **+** to open another and **Ctrl** + **W** to close the current one.
- LeafSide **remembers** the page, the exact position and the zoom of every file. When you open it again, you're right where you left off.
- When you close the app and open it again, the **tabs from your last session reopen**.

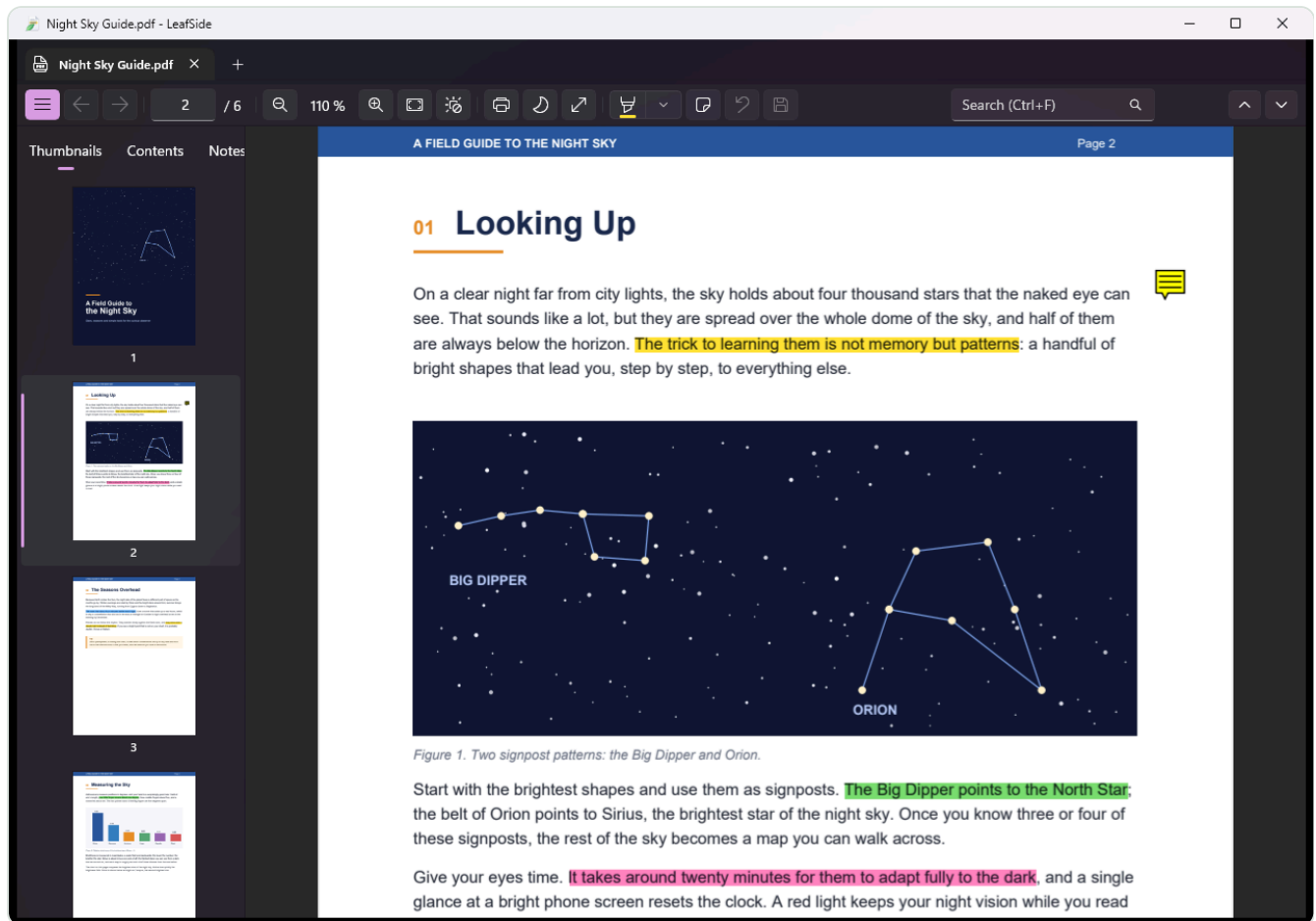
8 Printing

- 1 Press **Ctrl** + **P** or click the printer button (7).
- 2 In the Windows dialog, choose the printer, the pages and the number of copies, then confirm.
- 3 A bar shows the progress ("12 of 300 pages") and you can cancel at any time. You can keep reading meanwhile.

Pages print as sharp as possible and rotate automatically when they're landscape. To make a new PDF with just a few pages, choose the **Microsoft Print to PDF** printer.

9 Highlights and notes

Mark what matters and jot down your thoughts, just like on paper, without ever losing them.



Highlights in several colors and a note (the yellow icon on the right).

Highlighting text

- 1 Select the text by dragging across it.
- 2 Click the **highlighter** (button 10). Done! You can also right-click the selection > **Highlight** or **Highlight and comment**.

The arrow next to the highlighter picks the color: ■ yellow, ■ green, ■ blue and ■ pink.

Highlighting a lot?

Turn the highlighter on *without* anything selected: every piece of text you select is highlighted right away. Press Esc or click the button again to stop.

Adding a note

- 1 Click **Add note** (button 11), then click where you want it. You can also right-click the page > **Add note** here.
- 2 Type your note. It's saved when the box closes.

Commenting, recoloring or deleting

Click any highlight or note. A box opens where you can write a comment, pick another color or click Delete.

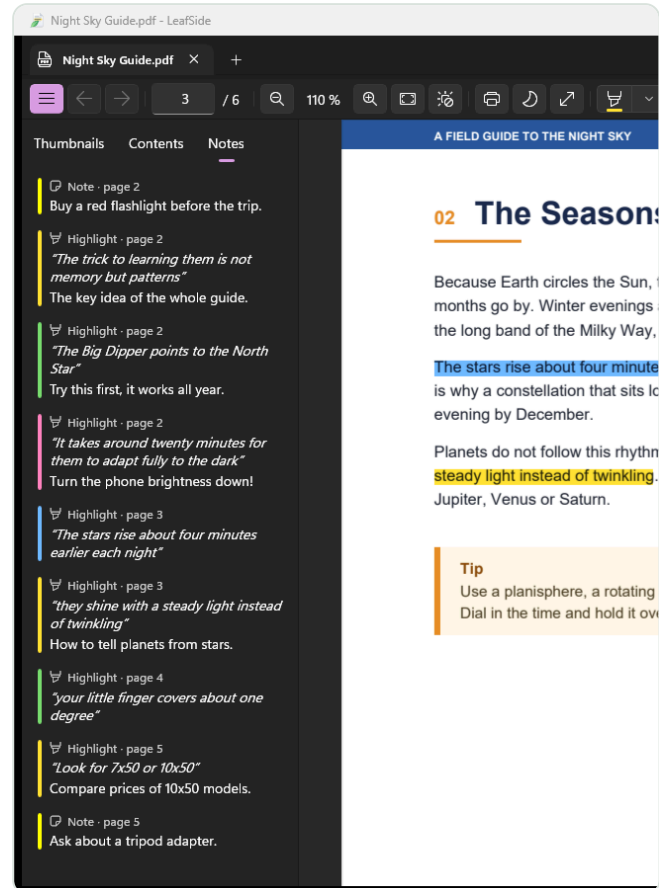
The Notes panel

In the side panel, the **Notes** tab gathers all your highlights and notes, with their page and your comment. Click any of them to jump straight to it.

It's perfect for reviewing a document at a glance or putting together a summary.

Saving your work

- Click **Save** (button 13) or press **Ctrl** + **S**.
Highlights and notes are written **into the PDF**, so Edge, Acrobat and phone apps show them too.
- Rather keep the original untouched? Press **Ctrl** + **Shift** + **S** to **Save as...** a copy.
- Made a mistake? **Ctrl** + **Z** undoes and **Ctrl** + **Y** redoes.



The Notes tab lists everything you've marked.

You won't lose anything

If you close a document with unsaved changes, LeafSide asks first: **Save**, **Don't save** or **cancel**. LeafSide only changes your PDF when you save, and if a save ever fails, the original file stays intact.

10 Comfortable reading

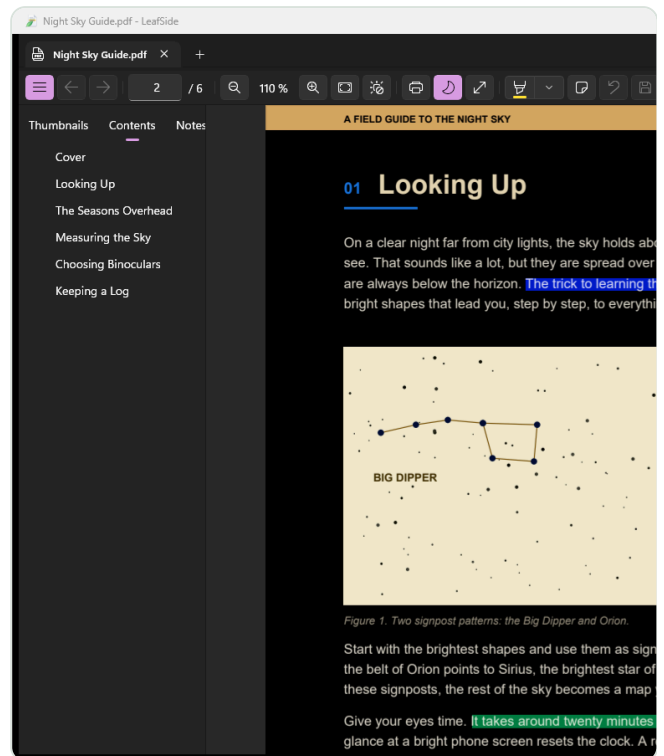
Night mode

Click the **moon** (button 8) to invert the page colors: dark background, light text. Easier on the eyes at night or in low light.

The setting applies to every tab and is remembered for next time. Click the moon again to turn it off.

Full screen

Press **F11** (or button 9) to let the document fill the screen with no bars. To leave, press **Esc** or **F11**. On touch screens, tap the screen and the **Exit full screen** button appears.



Night mode with the table of contents open.

Language: LeafSide is shown in Spanish when Windows is in Spanish, and in English otherwise.

11 Updates

Once a day, when it starts, LeafSide checks whether a new version is out. If there is one, you'll see a notice like this:



New version notice.

- If you use the installer, click **Download and install**: LeafSide gets the new version, checks that it arrived complete and untampered, closes and updates itself. You keep everything (positions, recent files and settings).
- If you use the portable version, the button says **Download** and saves the new .zip to your Downloads folder.
- **What's new** opens the page with the changes.
- **Skip this version** stops reminding you about that particular version.

Check for updates whenever you like with **Check for updates** on the start page, or turn the automatic check off with the checkbox right below it.

12 Keyboard shortcuts

Keys	What they do
Ctrl + O	Open a PDF
Ctrl + W	Close the tab
Ctrl + F, F3 / Shift + F3	Search; next / previous match
Ctrl + G	Go to a page
Ctrl + + / Ctrl + -	Zoom in / out
Ctrl + 0	Fit width
Alt + ← / Alt + →	Back / forward
Ctrl + P	Print
Ctrl + S / Ctrl + Shift + S	Save highlights and notes / save as
Ctrl + Z / Ctrl + Y	Undo / redo
Ctrl + C	Copy the selected text
F11, Esc	Full screen; exit
Space, PgDn / PgUp	Down / up one screen
Home / End	First / last page

13 Questions and answers

Will other programs show my highlights?

Yes, as soon as you save. They're stored as standard PDF annotations, the same kind Acrobat and Edge use.

It won't let me save

The file may be read-only or open in another program. LeafSide will offer to save a copy somewhere else.

I moved the portable folder and "Open with" stopped working

Run LeafSide.exe once from its new location and it fixes itself.

How do I uninstall it?

Installer: **Settings** > **Apps** > LeafSide > Uninstall. Portable version: delete the folder. To remove it from "Open with" as well, run **LeafSide.exe --unregister** first.

Where does LeafSide keep its data?

Reading positions, recent files and settings live in **%LocalAppData%\PdfReader**. Your PDFs always stay where they were.

Does LeafSide connect to the internet?

Only to check for updates: it asks GitHub for the latest version, without sending anything about you or your documents. No accounts, no ads, no usage tracking.

Does it cost anything?

No. LeafSide is free software (GNU GPL v3 license): you can use it, share it and study its code.

I found a bug or have an idea

Let us know! Open an issue at github.com/Jmzp/leafside/issues.



LeafSide · User guide · version 1.1.1

Happy reading!